

site. Once you have logged in, the welcome page has a well illustrated section to let you know about the community and its various sections. It is designed keeping in mind the demographics of the community, i.e. pre-teens.

Salary

Once you have a registered username and are logged in, you have the opportunity of earning virtual money by playing the various educational games that are available online. Your score in the game determines the amount of virtual money you earn. Your salary gets paid on every new day that you log into the site. The virtual money on WhyVille is called “clams”. Clams can then be used to buy specialised equipment like face parts for their avatar or projectiles which can be used in the games on the site or furniture to decorate their virtual space on the site. Users can sell their “face part” drawings on the online store called “Akbar’s Face Store” and receive clams in return.

Government

Users can participate as City workers to conduct a variety of chores for the virtual WhyVille city. In return they get paid a salary. Just like in the real world, WhyVille users can sign a petition and if it gets enough votes, the petition is polled amongst its members. If the polls favour the petition, it goes to the WhyVille City Hall for the City Workers to consider making it a law.

There is also a process in place to select a senate every 3 months in WhyVille which is again completely dominated by the community.

The Games

WhyVille has games such as Solstice Safari, The Skater Game, Balloon Race, Virus Design Lab, and the Spin Game, which is designed to teach kids the concepts of science and how to handle money better in a controlled and fun way. Users who have the most number of clams are well respected in the community and new ways of earning clams are always encouraged in the community by